

FS Organizer

User manual

Version 0.54.13

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Contents

1	What this program does	2
1.1	What the program does not store	2
1.2	Profile	2
1.3	Link type	2
2	Presets	3
2.1	What a preset holds	3
2.2	An applied preset	3
2.3	The three apply modes	3
2.4	What Replace disables by omission	4
2.5	The return preset	4
2.6	Presets and startup entries	4
3	First setup	6
4	Library	7
4.1	The columns	7
4.2	Enabling and disabling in bulk	7
4.3	Categories	8
4.4	Pinning the destination	8
4.5	Repointing	8
5	Destinations	9
5.1	Taking over another program's folder	10
6	Importing	11
6.1	Check after copying	11
6.2	Half finished imports	12
7	Quarantine	13
8	Deleting an addon from the library	14
9	Simulator	15
9.1	Startup entries	15
9.2	Package list	15
10	Documents	16
11	Diagnostics	17
11.1	Finding the culprit	17
12	Journal	19
13	Options	20
14	Where things are kept	21



1 What this program does

FS Organizer turns Microsoft Flight Simulator addons on and off without moving a single file.

Your addons live in a folder of your own, outside the simulator, which the program calls a **library**. Its subfolders become **categories**. Enabling an addon creates a link inside a folder the simulator reads, which the program calls a **destination**; disabling removes that link and nothing else. The real files never leave the library, and that is why swapping tens of gigabytes of content is instant.

The link is an NTFS directory junction. To the simulator it is the folder; to you it is an entry FS Organizer creates and removes.

1.1 What the program does not store

Whether an addon is enabled is **never written down anywhere**. On every scan the program reads the destinations from the disk and answers for what it found there. That has a practical consequence: moving folders around from the outside, with Explorer or with another program's installer, never leaves the app saying one thing while the simulator does another. Read again and it is current.

1.2 Profile

A **profile** is one simulator installation with its destinations and its libraries. Anyone running Flight Simulator 2020 and 2024 on the same machine has two profiles, and the program only touches what is in use: marking another one active is what switches the target of everything.

1.3 Link type

In **Options**, under **Links**, the program offers two types.

Directory junction

Needs no administrator and crosses local volumes. It is the default, and the only path that has been tested.

Symbolic link

Only for a library on a network path, where the junction does not reach. It needs a Windows privilege; without it the program explains the refusal instead of failing quietly.

Switching the type changes new links only. The ones that already exist stay as they are.



2 Presets

Presets come first in this manual because they are the part nobody gets right by trial. A preset looks like a list of addons, but it is a list of addons **plus an apply mode**, and the same preset gives three different results depending on the mode.

2.1 What a preset holds

A preset saves a set of enabled addons under a name. Enable what you want to fly with and use **New from enabled addons**.

The **Content** column says how many addons it names and how many categories they are in. The **Updated** column says when it was last saved.

A preset can also control the simulator's startup entries, covered in section 2.6.

2.2 An applied preset

The **If applied** column says how many addons would change state if you applied that preset now. When the number is zero, the table says **Already applied**.

This is always measured as Replace, even if you mean to apply the preset another way. A preset naming three addons, all enabled, shows as applied only if **nothing else** is enabled. If a fourth addon the preset does not name is enabled, the preset is not applied, because Replace would disable that fourth addon.

This is deliberate: the column answers “is my installation the way this preset describes it?”, and only Replace reads a preset as a description of the whole installation.

2.3 The three apply modes

Apply as chooses between three readings of the same preset.

Replace

Enables the preset's addons and disables everything else.

Accumulate

Enables the preset's addons and leaves the rest as it is.

Disable

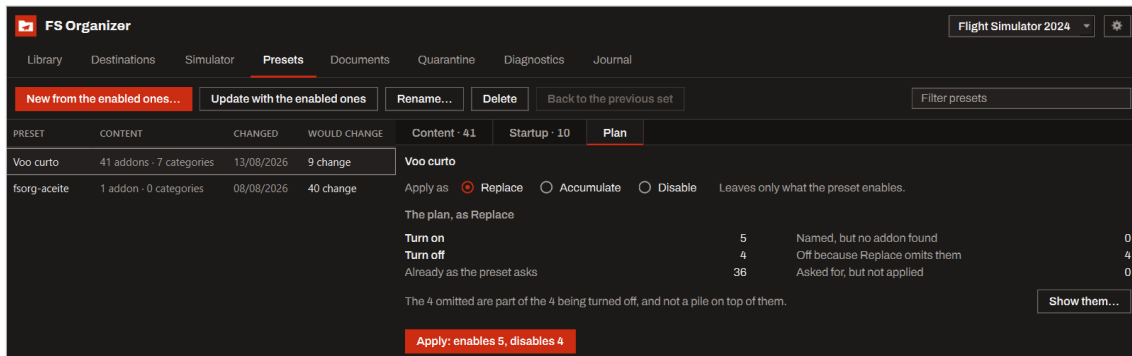
Disables the preset's addons. Addons the preset lists as disabled are ignored.

Before you apply, the **Plan** panel shows what will happen, in five groups that add up to the whole count:

- **To enable:** addons in the preset that are disabled now.
- **To disable:** addons going off, either because the preset says so or because Replace leaves them out.
- **Already as the preset asks:** nothing happens to them.



- **Not found in the library:** addons the preset names that are no longer in the library. The program lists them and applies the rest.
- **Requested, but not applied:** startup entries the preset asks for that could not be changed.



The plan of the “Voo curto” preset, read as Replace. The five groups add up to the whole count, and the sentence under them says the 4 not in the preset are among the 4 being disabled.

2.4 What Replace disables by omission

Applying as Replace disables the addons that are enabled now and that the preset does not name. They show up under **Disabled by Replace**, and **Show them** opens the list.

They are already included in the plan’s count. If the plan says “disables 12” and the list has 5 names, the total is still 12: 5 left out of the preset and 7 the preset asks to disable.

2.5 The return preset

Before applying any preset, the program **saves what is enabled at that moment** as the profile’s return preset. **Back to the previous set** applies it.

If it cannot be saved, because the presets folder is full or read-only, **nothing is applied**, so there is always a way back.

The return is not the same as **Undo last change**:

Undo last change

Undoes exactly what you just applied. An import or a quarantine operation done afterwards uses up the undo.

Back to the previous set

Applies the return preset, which is a preset like any other. It survives imports and quarantine operations, because it does not depend on the journal.

Applying a preset is a single batch: **Undo last change** takes all of it back at once.

2.6 Presets and startup entries

On the preset’s **Startup** tab, a checkbox makes the preset also control the programs the simulator launches with itself. Checking it saves the entries enabled at that moment, and



you can then enable or disable each one there.

If startup management is off in **Options**, the preset's entries **are not applied**, and the program says how many. The rest of the preset is applied normally.

If an entry the preset names is no longer in the simulator's file, it is listed instead of recreated. The program never adds a startup entry.



3 First setup

On the first run the program looks for simulator installations on the computer and asks for two things.

The simulator

Choose the installation this profile will manage from the list, or choose a folder yourself. If that folder does not look like the simulator's `Community` folder, the program says so and uses it anyway.

The library

Choose the folder outside the simulator where you keep your addons. Its subfolders become categories.

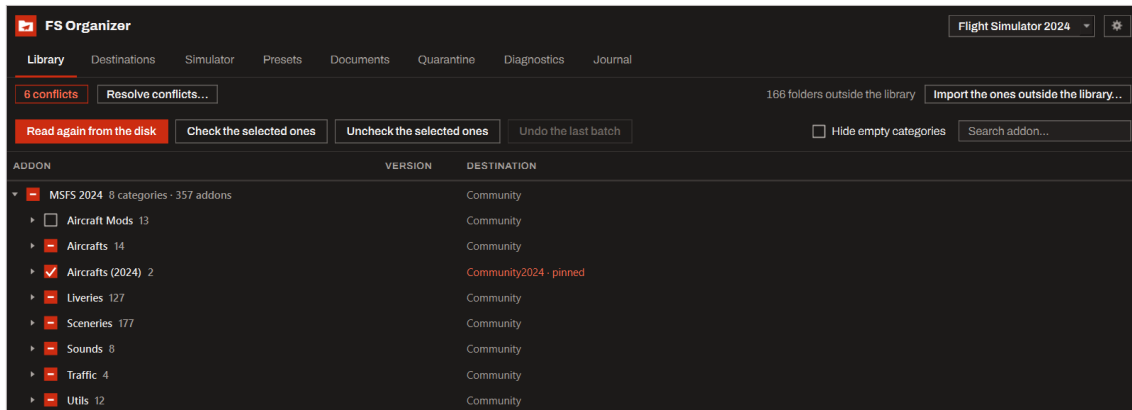
When you add a library with a long path, the program shows how many characters the path already takes and how many are left for the addon, next to a short path for comparison. Nothing is blocked: addons that go past the Windows limit say so when it matters, and **Diagnostics** shows the longest path in each library.

If you come from MSFS Addons Linker, you can bring its configuration over in **Options**, with **Import from MSFS Addons Linker**. No files are moved or deleted: importing adds the libraries, categories and presets that are not here yet.



4 Library

The **Library** tab is the tree of your addons, grouped by the categories that are the subfolders of the root. The checkbox on each row turns it on and off.



The library, with the categories open and the panel of the selected addon on the right.

4.1 The columns

Addon

The folder name.

Version

What the addon's manifest.json declares.

Enabled

Whether a link to it exists in a destination right now.

Destination

Which destination it is linked in, and whether that destination is pinned.

Link

Whether the link finds the folder. When it does not, the link is broken.

Three marks appear on a row when something is out of place: **Broken link**, **In conflict** and **Two copies**. Each one has a section in this manual.

4.2 Enabling and disabling in bulk

Selecting several rows and using **Enable selected** or **Disable selected** does it all in one batch. Past a certain number, the program asks first.

If an addon's spot is taken by another addon of yours, the program does not refuse: it offers the **swap**, which goes out and comes in as one operation, with one line in the journal and one undo.



4.3 Categories

The tree's context menu creates, renames and deletes categories, and moves addons between them. Only an empty category can be deleted.

Suggest categories reads rules about the folder name and about the `manifest.json` and proposes moving whatever is out of place. The rules that are reliable come checked; the livery rule is often wrong, so it comes unchecked: review it before applying.

A folder counts as a category while it groups addons, and the program writes a hidden `.fsorg-category` inside the ones it knows about so that a category which loses its last addon keeps being one. It marks them when it registers the library, and **Categories** in the options marks them again later.

A folder that groups no addon and carries no `manifest.json` of its own is treated as an addon, so it can be enabled, moved and deleted like any other. That is what a converted package the simulator writes beside yours looks like, and what a scenery object library that ships without a manifest looks like too.

4.4 Pinning the destination

By default an addon is linked in the profile's default destination. **Always use**, followed by a destination, ties an addon or a whole category to it. When a pinning names a folder that has stopped being a destination of the profile, the program says so and uses the default destination while that is true, without deleting the pinning from the configuration.

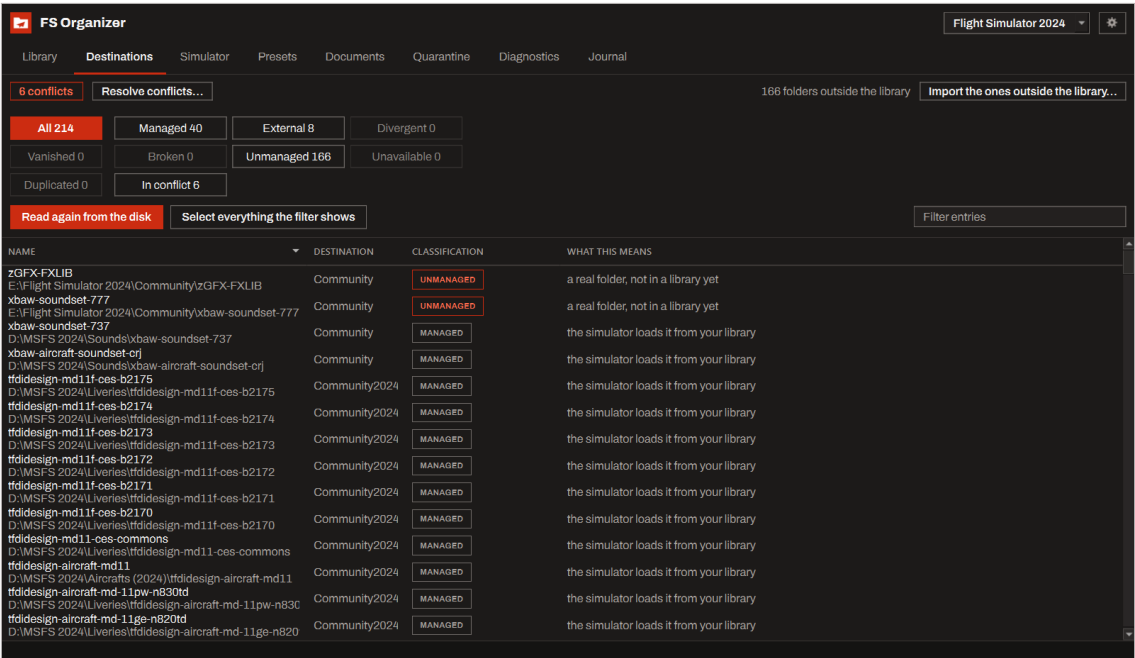
4.5 Repointing

When a link exists but points at the wrong place, or at a folder that is gone, **Repoint to the library** fixes it. Repairing never touches the real files: only the reparse node is rewritten.



5 Destinations

The **Destinations** tab shows everything inside the folders the simulator reads, including what is not yours. Each entry gets a classification.



The destinations, with the classification filter at the top and the count of each kind in the footer.

Managed

The simulator loads it from your library. This is the normal state.

External

A regular folder another program installed, not in a library yet.

Divergent

The other program put its own copy back, so there are two copies.

Vanished

The library copy is gone, removed by the other program. There is nothing to repair: the files no longer exist on this computer.

Broken

The link points to a folder that does not exist.

Unavailable

The drive is not connected right now. It can come back, so the program offers no cleanup.

Unmanaged

A regular folder, not in a library yet.

Duplicated

Linked in more than one destination.

**Substituted**

Something wrote a regular folder over a link this program made. The simulator loads that folder and ignores the library copy.

The filter at the top narrows the list by classification, and **Select all shown** selects exactly what is visible.

5.1 Taking over another program's folder

Import this folder moves the folder into your library and leaves a link in its place. From then on it is an addon of yours like any other.

The risk is that **the other program will not know about the link**. Its next update may write into the link, or replace it with a regular folder and leave you with two copies. When that happens, the entry shows up as **Divergent** and the program asks which copy to keep.

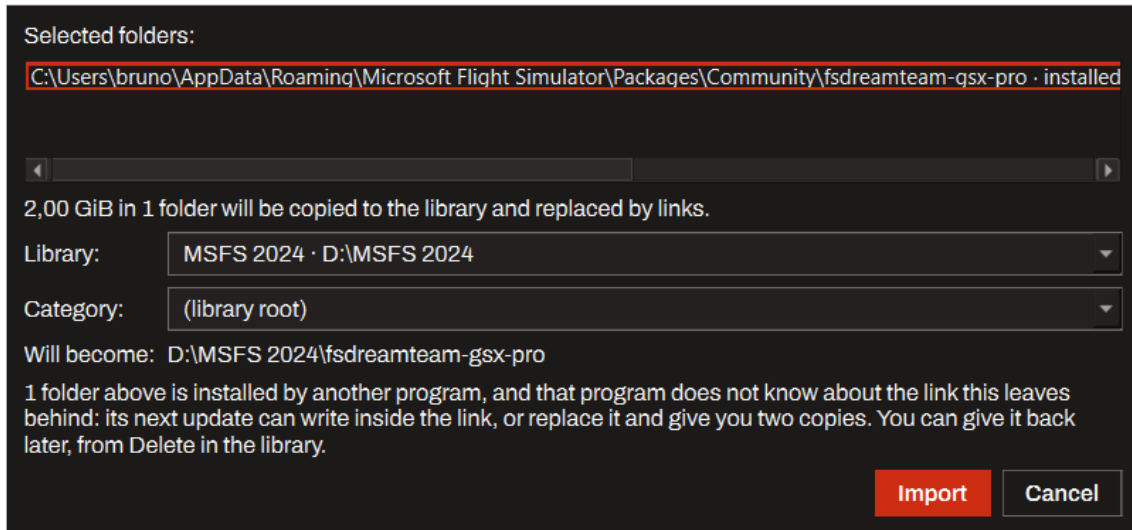
You can give the addon back to the program that installed it later, through **Delete from the library**.



6 Importing

Importing copies a regular folder into the library and leaves a link in its place. The original is removed only after the copy is verified.

The operation has five steps, and the journal records each one:



The import dialog, which says how much is about to be copied, into which library and category, and where the addon will end up.

1. Copy to a temporary folder.
2. Check the copy.
3. Put the copy in place.
4. Remove the source folder.
5. Create the link in the destination.

While the copy runs, a window shows which folder it is on, how far it has got and a **Cancel** button. Cancelling deletes nothing: what was already copied stays where it is, for the resume.

6.1 Check after copying

In **Options**, under **Links**, the check comes in two forms.

By structure

Checks the count and the size of every file. It is the default.

By hash

Reads both sides in full and compares the bytes, which catches a change the size hides. It makes an import several times slower, and the number of files weighs more than their size.

If the copy does not match, nothing is removed.



6.2 Half finished imports

If an import is interrupted, the next time the program opens it offers three choices: resume, discard the partial copy, or leave it as is. The original files are still where they were, and nothing was removed from the destination.

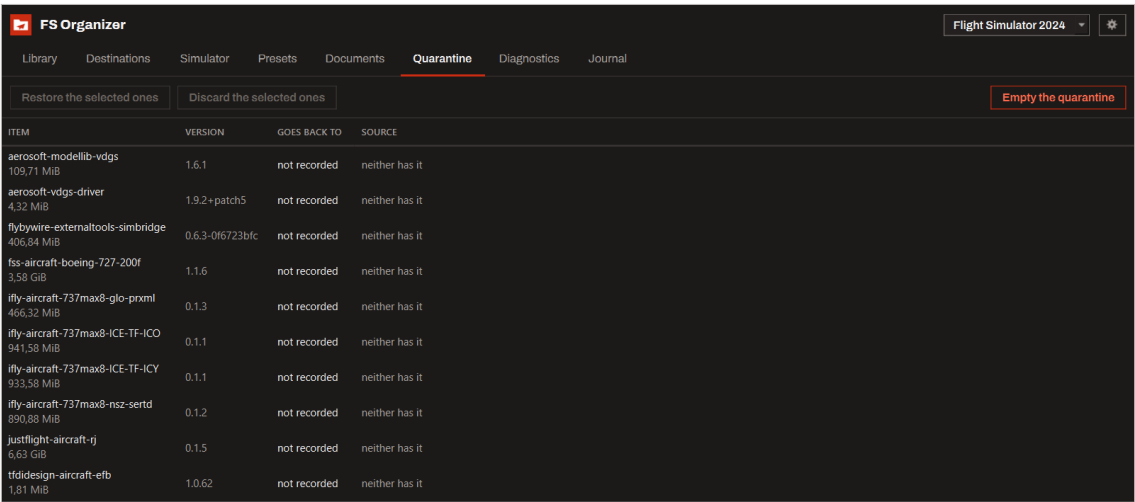
If the interrupted operation was a conflict resolution, the copy can only be discarded, because both copies are still in place.



7 Quarantine

When you resolve a conflict between two copies of an addon, the copy you do not keep goes to the quarantine instead of being deleted. **Nothing leaves the quarantine unless you ask**, and nothing is deleted on the way in.

Next to each item the program records where it came from. That record does not depend on the journal, so an item can be restored even if the journal is gone. The table shows both sources, **The record says** and **The Journal says**, and flags when they disagree.



ITEM	VERSION	GOES BACK TO	SOURCE
aerosoft-modellib-vdgs 109,71 MiB	1.6.1	not recorded	neither has it
aerosoft-vdgs-driver 4,32 MiB	1.9.2+patch5	not recorded	neither has it
flybywire-externaltools-simbridge 406,84 MiB	0.6.3-0f6723bfc	not recorded	neither has it
fss-aircraft-boeing-727-200f 3,58 GiB	1.1.6	not recorded	neither has it
ifly-aircraft-737max8-glo-prxml 466,32 MiB	0.1.3	not recorded	neither has it
ifly-aircraft-737max8-ICE-TF-ICO 941,58 MiB	0.1.1	not recorded	neither has it
ifly-aircraft-737max8-ICE-TF-ICY 933,58 MiB	0.1.1	not recorded	neither has it
ifly-aircraft-737max8-nsz-serstd 890,88 MiB	0.1.2	not recorded	neither has it
justflight-aircraft-rj 6,63 GiB	0.1.5	not recorded	neither has it
tfdidesign-aircraft-efb 1,81 MiB	1.0.62	not recorded	neither has it

The quarantine, with the origin of each item and the flag for when the record and the journal disagree.

Restore sends each folder back to where it came from. Nothing is overwritten: conflicts are listed with both versions, and replacing moves what is there to the quarantine. **Discard** deletes permanently, and asks first.



8 Deleting an addon from the library

Delete offers three routes, and says up front when one of them will not work.

Move to the Recycle Bin

You can restore it from the Recycle Bin. The program refuses this route when the selection does not fit in the Recycle Bin of that volume, or when the addon holds a path past the 260 characters the Recycle Bin stops at. Windows may remove older items from the Bin to make room.

Delete permanently

This cannot be undone.

Give it back to the program that installed it

Only offered for an addon that came from another program. The files move back to the folder that program keeps them in, and leave the library.

Turning the addon off is part of the deletion and happens because you asked for it: the link goes with the addon.



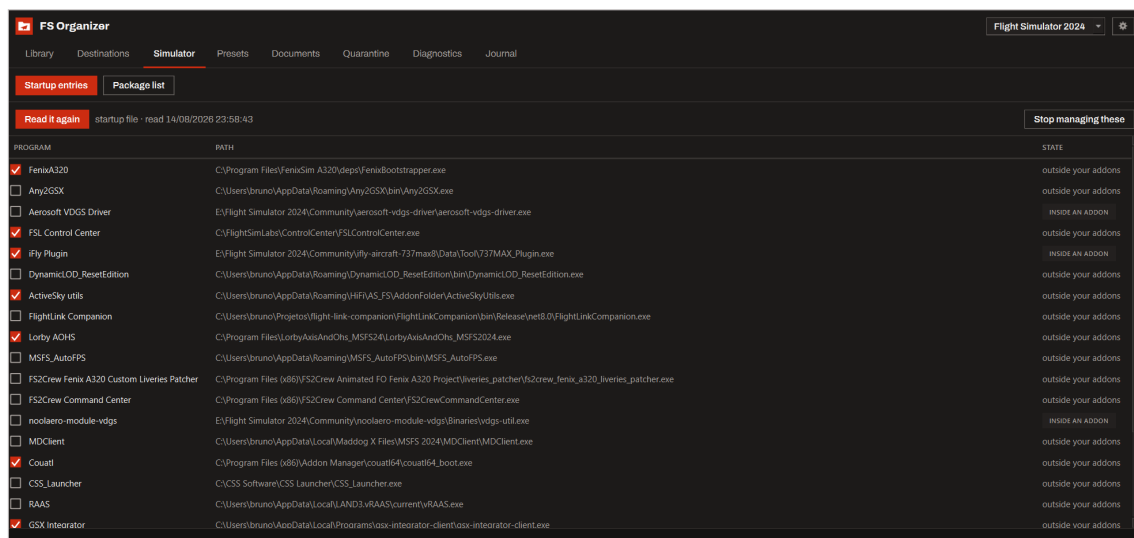
9 Simulator

The **Simulator** tab has two panels, and both change files that belong to the simulator. For both, the program keeps a backup of the file next to it, and neither changes anything while the simulator is running.

9.1 Startup entries

The simulator has a file (`EXE.xml`) that lists the programs it launches with itself. The **Startup entries** panel shows them and lets you enable or disable each one without editing XML.

The program **only enables or disables entries that already exist**. It never adds, removes or reorders them.



The startup entries, with the program each one launches and its switch.

This panel starts off, and while it is off the program neither reads nor writes that file.

When you disable an addon that has a startup entry, the program warns first: if the entry stayed enabled, the simulator would keep trying to launch a program that is no longer there. Disabling both is a single operation, with one line in the journal and one undo.

9.2 Package list

The simulator ships its own airports. When one of your airports covers the same place as one of them, the **Package list** panel shows the pair and lets you disable the simulator's airport.

Disabling it changes **one value** in the package list. Nothing is added, removed or reordered, and an entry without that value is left alone rather than edited, because invalid XML makes the simulator reset the whole list.

For two addons **of your own**, the program only shows the pair: to choose one, disable the other on the **Library** tab.

This panel also starts off, and while it is off the file is neither read nor written.

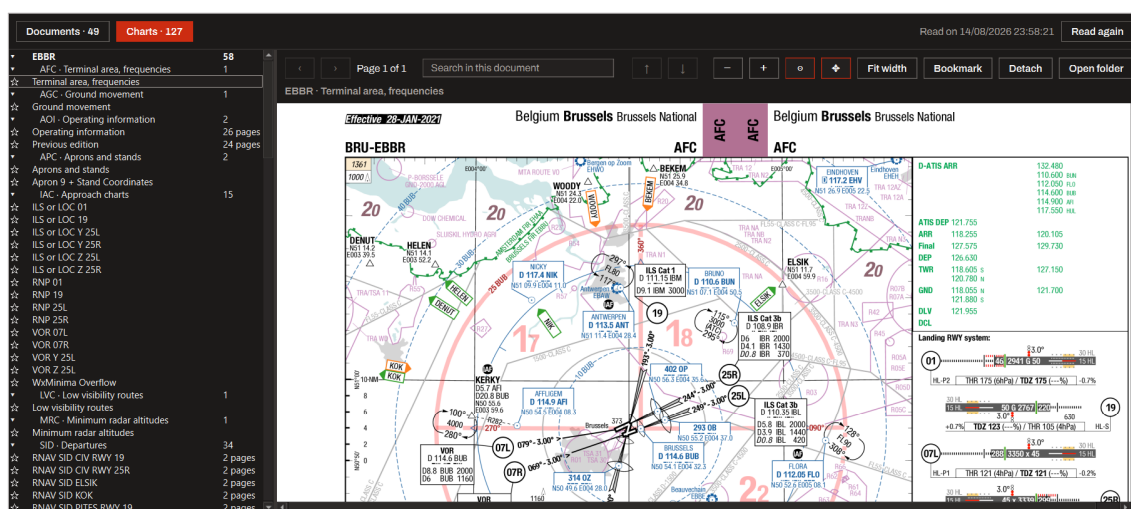


10 Documents

The **Documents** tab finds the PDFs your addons include and opens them inside the program. **Scan the library** looks for PDFs in every addon, and the result is saved, so later scans are quick.

What it finds is split in two: **Documents** and **Charts**. One addon can include one manual and a hundred and fifty charts, which is why the count comes before the list. Charts are grouped by airport, and by type when the addon ships a catalogue describing them.

The reader has an outline, search, fit to width and bookmarks. A bookmark you do not name takes the page number. **Open in a separate window** moves the reader out of the tab.



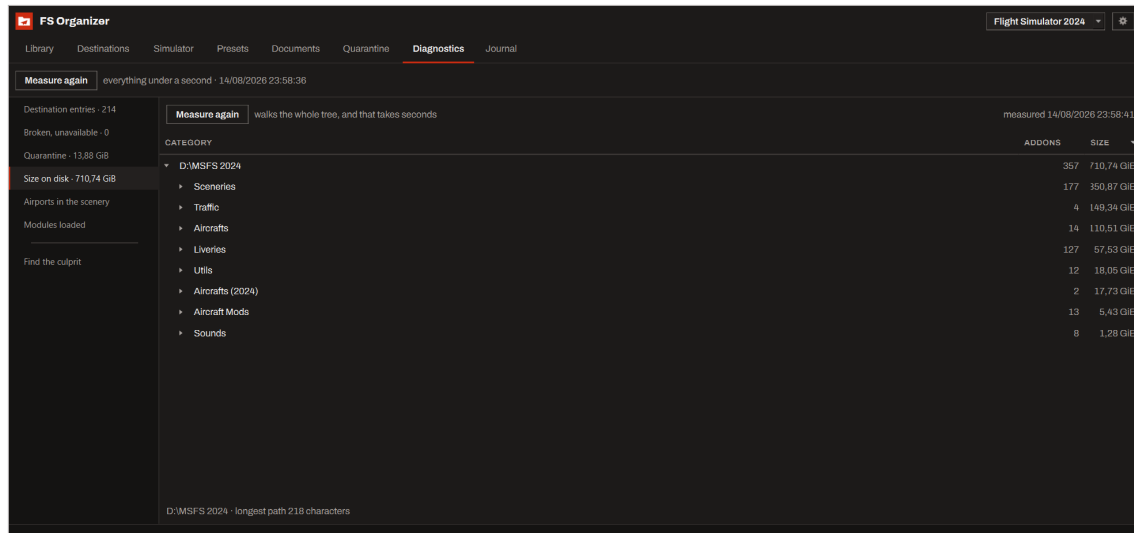
The documents tab: charts grouped by airport on the left, the reader in the middle and the outline of the document on the right.

Charts and documents start with different settings: on a chart the mouse wheel zooms and dragging moves the page; on a document both start off. The two toggles on the toolbar say what they do.



11 Diagnostics

The **Diagnostics** tab reports what the scan found. Every number shows when it was measured, and you can measure again at any time.



The size on disk section, with the total per category and per addon, and the time of the measurement.

Destination entries

How many entries there are of each kind, and the longest path in each library.

Broken or unavailable

What is broken and what is on a disconnected drive, with a button to repair the broken links.

Quarantine

How much space the quarantine takes. Nothing is emptied from here.

Size on disk

How much each category and each addon takes. It may take a few seconds; **Stop** stops after the addon being measured.

Airports in the scenery

Scans the scenery of every addon and sorts it into addons with an airport code, with an unreadable airport record, with navigation data instead of scenery, and without an airport record.

Modules loaded

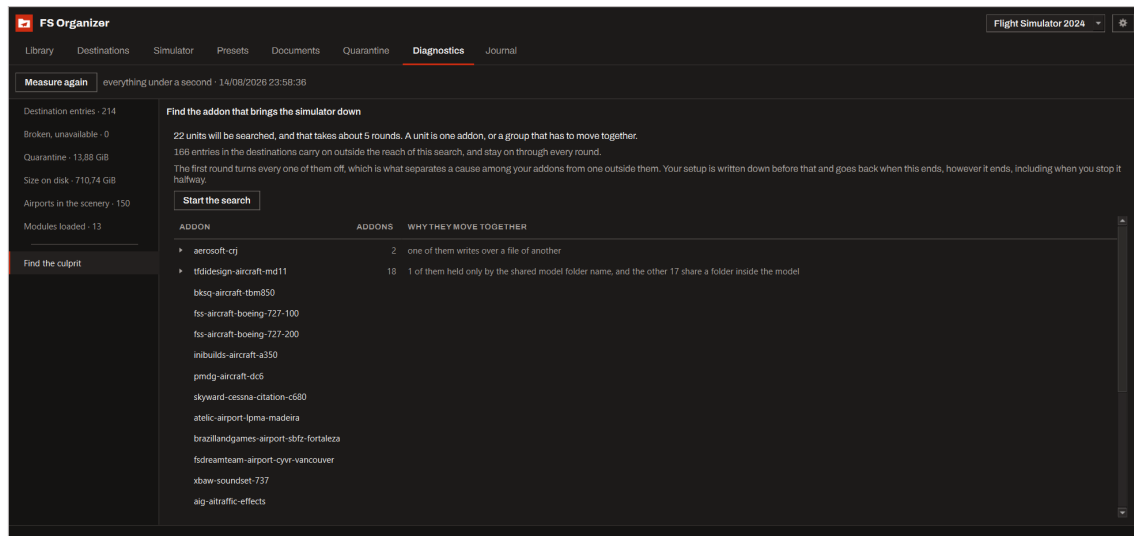
Reads the report the simulator writes after a slow load. The simulator does not report loading time per package, so this shows which module each package loaded and how much memory it holds.

11.1 Finding the culprit

When the simulator crashes and you do not know which addon causes it, **Find the culprit** searches by halves. It disables half of your addons, you launch the simulator and answer **It crashed** or **It worked**, and each round rules out half of the suspects.



Before you start:



The search for the culprit, with the current round, what has been ruled out and the two answers the user gives.

- The search works on **units**: one addon, or a group of addons that must stay together because they share a model folder. The panel says why a group is together, and offers to split it when that is safe.
- The first round disables **all** your addons, to tell whether the cause is among them at all.
- Your setup is saved before the first round and restored when the search ends, however it ends. If the program is closed during the search, it offers to restore it the next time it opens.

The search assumes a single culprit. If the crash only happens with two addons enabled together, the result may point to the wrong one, and the panel says so.



12 Journal

Every operation that writes to the disk becomes a line in the **Journal**. Lines are only ever added, nothing on this screen writes to the disk, and **the program never deletes it**.

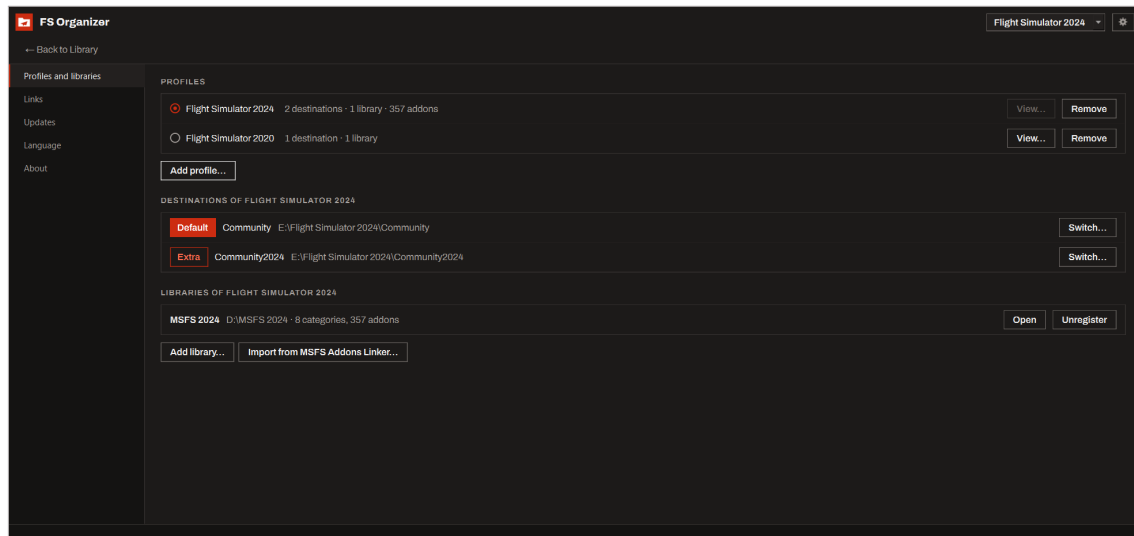
Each line shows when, which operation, which addon, which library, source, destination and result. **Failures only** narrows the list to what went wrong, and the search covers addon, path and operation.

Undo last change, on the **Library** tab, takes back the whole last batch, not one operation inside it.



13 Options

The gear in the header opens the options, in five tabs.



The profiles and libraries tab of the options.

Profiles and libraries

Adds and removes profiles, changes destinations, and adds and removes libraries. Removing a library deletes no files: links that pointed at it keep working in the simulator, but FS Organizer stops managing them. **Categories** says how many category folders of that library are already marked and how many would be, and marks them or removes all markers.

Links

The link type and how imports are verified.

Updates

Automatic, notify or manual. Automatic downloads new versions and installs them when you close the program.

Language

English and Brazilian Portuguese. The change takes effect right away, with no restart.

About

The version, the licence and the credits.



14 Where things are kept

The whole configuration of the program lives under `%LOCALAPPDATA%\fs-organizer`, like this:

`settings.json` holds the profiles, the libraries, the destinations and your choices.

`journal\operations.jsonl` is the journal.

`presets` holds the presets, one file per preset, plus the return preset of each profile.

`bisection` holds the state of a search for the culprit that is under way. It stops existing when the search ends.

None of your addon files live there. Deleting that folder deletes the configuration and the presets, and touches no addon: the program rebuilds what it knows by reading the destinations and the libraries again.

One thing the program writes outside that folder: the hidden `.fsorg-category` it leaves in the folders of your library that group addons. It holds nothing, and its whole job is to keep a category counting as one after it empties. **Categories** in the options takes every one of them back.